

Project Scope Management

SECTION: Definition

Scope management ensures the project includes all the work required — and only the work required — to complete the project successfully. It has two dimensions:

- **Product scope:** features and functions of the product/service/result.
- **Project scope:** the work that must be done to deliver the product with the specified features.

SECTION: Key Processes

1. **Plan Scope Management** — defines how scope will be defined, validated, and controlled.
2. **Collect Requirements** — determining and documenting stakeholder needs (interviews, surveys, focus groups, workshops, prototypes).
3. **Define Scope** — developing a detailed **Project Scope Statement** (deliverables, boundaries, acceptance criteria, exclusions, constraints, assumptions).
4. **Create WBS (Work Breakdown Structure)** — subdividing deliverables into smaller, manageable components.
5. **Validate Scope** — formalizing acceptance of completed deliverables with the customer/sponsor.
6. **Control Scope** — monitoring project/product scope status and managing changes to the scope baseline.

SECTION: Work Breakdown Structure (WBS)

A hierarchical decomposition of the total scope of work, organized around deliverables (not activities).

Key rules:

- Follows the **100% Rule**: the WBS includes 100% of the work defined by the project scope, and captures all deliverables — internal, external, interim.
- The lowest level is called a **work package** — small enough to estimate cost/duration and assign to a single owner.
- Typically decomposed to 3–4 levels; going too deep creates excessive management overhead ("analysis paralysis").
- Accompanied by a **WBS Dictionary**, which describes each component in detail (deliverable, work, owner, cost, resources).

SECTION: Scope Creep vs Gold Plating

- **Scope creep**: uncontrolled, unapproved expansion of scope, usually adding small changes ("just one more feature") without adjusting time/cost/resources. A common cause of project overruns, especially in IT.

- **Gold plating:** a team member unilaterally adds extra features/functionality beyond what was requested, believing it adds value — this wastes resources and can introduce scope/requirement mismatches even though the client didn't ask for it.

Both are controlled via a formal **Scope Change Control Process** (often part of Integrated Change Control), requiring changes to go through a Change Control Board (CCB) before being approved.

SECTION: Requirements Traceability Matrix (RTM)

A table linking requirements to their origin (stakeholder need) and tracking them throughout the project life cycle to ensure each requirement is delivered and tested — nothing is lost, and nothing extra creeps in.

SECTION: Scope Baseline

Consists of three approved components:

1. Project Scope Statement
2. WBS
3. WBS Dictionary

Any change to the scope baseline must go through the formal change control process; this baseline is what "control scope" measures actual performance against.

SECTION: Common Exam Angles

- Build or interpret a simple WBS for a described project.
- Distinguish scope creep from gold plating with examples.
- Explain the 100% Rule and why work packages shouldn't be too granular or too broad.
- Identify components of the scope baseline.